Reading and writing

2026-11-17 | Week 6 | Observe and explain

Grade 3 | TEKS 3.8C

3.8C: Analyze plot elements, including the sequence of events, the conflict, and the resolution. In plain English: Explain the order of story events, the problem and how it is solved. Today: Sequence how the unwanted pumpkins grow.

Grade 4 | TEKS 4.8B

4.8B: Explain the interactions of the characters and the changes they undergo. In plain English: Explain how characters affect one another and how they change during the story. Today: Explain how she responds when the pumpkins keep growing.

I Do

Read a short, accessible scene from A Chair for My Mother. Grade 3: say, "We are learning to sequence how the unwanted pumpkins grow." and model one response with a picture, prop or dictated sentence. Grade 4: say, "We are learning to explain how she responds when the pumpkins keep growing." and model a response that points to the same scene as evidence.

We Do

Reread the same scene aloud. Both learners handle the same book, illustrations and props. Grade 3 practices the target by arranging, pointing, speaking, using AAC or dictating a response. Grade 4 practices the separate target by explaining, comparing or citing evidence from that same scene. Fade the model, return to the page, then switch teacher rotations.

You Do

Use one fresh question about A Chair for My Mother. Grade 3: Sequence how the unwanted pumpkins grow. Grade 4: Explain how she responds when the pumpkins keep growing. Record each response, the page or illustration used and the help given.

Rotate and switch

Teacher with Grade 3 for 8-10 minutes while Grade 4 uses the taught independent task; switch. Match supports to each learner, not the grade label. Independent task: The learner not with the teacher uses a previously taught response sort, scene sequence, prop match or known Vizzle task from A Chair for My Mother; the teacher then switches and teaches the other learner from the same scene.

Access and participation

Use objects or two clear choices, the learner's planned response method and wait time. Offer a private response or equivalent retry when needed; record extra help and no response separately.

Evidence and progress

Save one dated response for each grade's target above: a model/photo, selected answer, dictated sentence or work sample. Record correct / total and extra prompts separately. This is practice evidence unless today is a scheduled graded product. Use it for IEP progress only if it measures the actual goal under its required conditions; goals are awaiting upload.

Materials

Real books: A Chair for My Mother. Bring the props and response mats in the weekly book guide.

Writing TEKS 3.7B

Write a response to a literary or informational text that demonstrates an understanding of a text.

Writing TEKS 4.7B

Write responses that demonstrate understanding of texts, including comparing and contrasting ideas across a variety of sources.

Writing and spelling

After the shared read-aloud, each learner makes an individual response from the same book. Grade 3: Sequence how the unwanted pumpkins grow. Grade 4: Explain how she responds when the pumpkins keep growing. Use the planned response mode and record composition separately from oral or picture evidence.

8-9 AM read-aloud

Too Many Pumpkins by Linda White. Return to the real pages for evidence; see the weekly book guide.

Math

2026-11-17 | Week 6 | Observe and explain

Grade 3 | TEKS 3.3C, 3.3D

3.3C: Explain that the unit fraction 1/b represents the quantity formed by one part of a whole that has been partitioned into b equal parts where b is a non-zero whole number. In plain English: Explain that a unit fraction is one equal part of a whole. 3.3D: Compose and decompose a fraction a/b with a numerator greater than zero and less than or equal to b as a sum of parts 1/b. In plain English: Build and break apart a fraction as a sum of unit fractions. Today: Make one whole from fourths; separate it into two smaller fractional amounts.

Grade 4 | TEKS 4.3C, 4.3D

4.3C: Determine if two given fractions are equivalent using a variety of methods. In plain English: Determine whether two fractions name the same amount. 4.3D: Compare two fractions with different numerators and different denominators and represent the comparison using the symbols >, =, or <. In plain English: Compare fractions with different numerators and denominators using >, = or <. Today: Compare one half with three fourths using matching whole lengths.

I Do

Grade 3: Join three one-fourth pieces to make three fourths. Separate into two fourths and one fourth. Grade 4: Place one half and one fourth on equal-size wholes. Show the greater amount and compare two fourths with one half.

We Do

Both students handle the shared materials. Practice one example with the teacher; then teach the two targets in separate rotations. Grade 4: compare 1/2 and 3/4 on equal-length wholes and record 1/2 < 3/4. This pair has different numerators and denominators.

You Do

Grade 3: Make one whole from fourths; separate it into two smaller fractional amounts. Grade 4: Compare one half with three fourths using matching whole lengths.

Rotate and switch

Teacher with Grade 3 for 8-10 minutes while Grade 4 uses the taught independent task; switch. Match supports to each learner, not the grade label. Independent task: Complete a mastered counting/sorting tray or known Bridges practice task at the student's established level.

Access and participation

Use objects or two clear choices, the learner's planned response method and wait time. Offer a private response or equivalent retry when needed; record extra help and no response separately.

Evidence and progress

Save one dated response for each grade's target above: a model/photo, selected answer, dictated sentence or work sample. Record correct / total and extra prompts separately. This is practice evidence unless today is a scheduled graded product. Use it for IEP progress only if it measures the actual goal under its required conditions; goals are awaiting upload.

Materials

Counters, plates/cups and the linked math mat. Select the matching grade-level STEMscopes lesson. Use Bridges placement to choose a separate foundational intervention.

Science

2026-11-17 | Week 6 | Observe and explain

Grade 3 | TEKS 3.8A

3.8A: Identify everyday examples of energy, including light, sound, thermal, and mechanical. In plain English: Recognize everyday examples of light, sound, thermal and mechanical energy. Today: Identify everyday forms of energy.

Grade 4 | TEKS 4.7

4.7: Plan and conduct descriptive investigations to explore the patterns of forces such as gravity, friction, or magnetism in contact or at a distance on an object. In plain English: Plan and conduct investigations to find patterns in gravity, friction or magnetism. Today: Test a pattern in gravity, friction or magnetism.

I Do

Grade 3: Show a flashlight, shaker, safely lukewarm sealed bottle and moving car. Name light, sound, thermal and mechanical energy. Grade 4: Compare the same car on smooth board and felt; test a magnet near a paper clip; release a ball into a tray.

We Do

Predict with objects or pictures, test together, then identify what changed. Keep one test variable different and other relevant conditions the same.

You Do

Grade 3: Match an object to its energy form; demonstrate one observable change. Grade 4: Show friction, magnetic attraction or gravity using observed evidence.

Rotate and switch

Teacher with Grade 3 for 8-10 minutes while Grade 4 uses the taught independent task; switch. Match supports to each learner, not the grade label. Independent task: Sort familiar object/photo matches away from the experiment station. Experiments are adult supervised.

Access and participation

Use objects or two clear choices, the learner's planned response method and wait time. Offer a private response or equivalent retry when needed; record extra help and no response separately.

Evidence and progress

Save one dated response for each grade's target above: a model/photo, selected answer, dictated sentence or work sample. Record correct / total and extra prompts separately. This is practice evidence unless today is a scheduled graded product. Use it for IEP progress only if it measures the actual goal under its required conditions; goals are awaiting upload.

Materials

Toy car, low ramp, stable blocks, felt, tray, tape, fraction strips, historical pictures. Adult manages circuit parts, magnets, small items and warm materials; use a low-voltage kit only.

Social studies

2026-11-17 | Week 6 | Observe and explain

Grade 3 | TEKS 3.14B

3.14B: Differentiate and compare the information about a specific issue or event provided in primary and secondary sources. In plain English: Compare what firsthand sources and later accounts say about the same issue or event. Today: Compare an original photo with a later account of the same event.

Grade 4 | TEKS 4.3A

4.3A: Analyze the causes, major events, and effects of the Texas Revolution, including the Battle of the Alamo, the Texas Declaration of Independence, the Runaway Scrape, and the Battle of San Jacinto. In plain English: Explain causes, major events and effects of the Texas Revolution. Today: Place two major Revolution events in order.

I Do

Grade 3: Compare an original photo with a later account of the same event. Model with one district source, naming the visible clue. Grade 4: Place two major Revolution events in order. Use the current Texas history map, image or excerpt; name the person/event and point to the evidence.

We Do

Work together with a second example from the same source set. Student circles/points to the part of the source that answers the question. Keep the grade-specific question visible and fade added hints.

You Do

Grade 3: Compare an original photo with a later account of the same event. Grade 4: Place two major Revolution events in order. Use a fresh source/card; accept a model, pointing, AAC or a spoken explanation.

Rotate and switch

Teacher with Grade 3 for 8-10 minutes while Grade 4 uses the taught independent task; switch. Match supports to each learner, not the grade label. Independent task: Match two familiar source pictures or complete a known picture-to-object task.

Access and participation

Use objects or two clear choices, the learner's planned response method and wait time. Offer a private response or equivalent retry when needed; record extra help and no response separately.

Evidence and progress

Save one dated response for each grade's target above: a model/photo, selected answer, dictated sentence or work sample. Record correct / total and extra prompts separately. This is practice evidence unless today is a scheduled graded product. Use it for IEP progress only if it measures the actual goal under its required conditions; goals are awaiting upload.

Materials

District source pictures or excerpts, two-event sequence mat and writing/history frames. The classroom texts do not replace Texas history sources.